REPUBLIC OF KENYA
MINISTRY OF TOURISM AND WILDLIFE
STATE DEPARTMENT FOR WILDLIFE

GEF 8 Q1 PROGRESS REPORT
OPERATIONAL FOCAL POINT (OFP)

FY27 Q1 | 1 July–30 September 2026

1. PROJECT INFORMATION

ITEM	DESCRIPTION / RESPONSE
Project Title	Advancing Human-Wildlife Conflict Management Effectiveness in Kenya through an Integrated Approach
GEF Cycle	GEF-8
GEF ID / Code	11153
Implementing Agency	Conservation International (CI)
Executing Entity	Ministry of Tourism and Wildlife – State Department for Wildlife (SDW)
Implementing Partners	KWS; WRTI; KWCA; LCA; TTWCA
Reporting Period	FY27 Q1: 1 July–30 September 2026
Project Duration	June 2026–September 2030
Project Location	Kenya: Laikipia, Meru and Taita Taveta (Tsavo) Landscapes
Project Objectives	Mitigate biodiversity loss driven by Human-Wildlife Conflict (HWC) by strengthening institutional capacity, coordination and knowledge exchange.
Project Components	1. Integrated HWC management capacity; 2. Zoonotic/animal disease surveillance and management; 3. Community-led conservation and sustainable livelihoods; 4. Coordination, learning and knowledge management; 5. Monitoring and Evaluation.
Expected Outputs	Command-center and communications readiness; HWC action plans and mitigation; zoonotic surveillance capacity; conservancy grants/livelihood support; coordination and knowledge products; monitoring and reporting.
Expected Outcomes	Improved institutional capacity and coordination for HWC management, reduced biodiversity loss, stronger disease surveillance, community-led conservation and sustainable livelihoods. Q1 does not yet demonstrate end-of-project outcome changes.
Alignment to National Priorities	Supports Kenya wildlife conservation and HWC mitigation priorities through coordinated response, biodiversity protection, zoonotic disease surveillance, community-led conservation and inclusive livelihoods; ProDoc aligns with national wildlife policy and action-planning frameworks.
Total Budget	GEF grant: US$9,585,932; confirmed co-financing: US$54,427,345 (ProDoc).
GEF Budget	US$9,585,932
Total Co-Finance Budget	US$54,427,345
Co-finance Budget (Cash)	Nil
Co-finance Budget (In-kind)	US$ 54,427,345

Links to policies/plans	Links to Kenya's national wildlife conservation policies and plans, including the Wildlife Conservation and Management Act, 2013; National Wildlife Strategy 2030; and National Human-Wildlife Coexistence Strategy and Action Plan (2024–2033).

2. SUMMARY

SUMMARY ITEM	DESCRIPTION / RESPONSE
Overall Implementation Status	**AMBER** — Early implementation underway; KWCA and landscape associations progressed planned activities. Delayed Exchequer disbursement was experienced; procurement processes commenced. PMU constituted, but Procurement Officer and Environmental and Social Safeguards personnel are not yet onboarded.
Key Achievements	Earth Ranger command-center technical, operational and site assessments completed across Laikipia, Tsavo and Meru; HWC data-review and community consultations held; PSC constituted and appointment letters issued; PMU team constituted, key procurements initiated.
Strategic Relevance	Supports integrated HWC response, biodiversity protection, zoonotic disease surveillance, community-led conservation and inclusive livelihoods.
Relevant Commitments (SDGs, MEAs, Agenda 2030)	The project contributes to biodiversity conservation and sustainable, inclusive community conservation.

3. IMPLEMENTATION PROGRESS PER COMPONENT

COMPONENT	ACTIVITIES UNDERTAKEN / OUTPUTS DELIVERED / COMPLETION / MID-TERM COMMENTS / RESPONSIBLE INSTITUTIONS
Component 1 – Institutional capacity for integrated HWC management	Technical/operational/site assessments for one command center and two sub-centers completed across Laikipia, Tsavo and Meru. Communications needs assessments completed; procurement packages and physical works pending. LCA HWC data-review workshop: 57 participants. TTWCA toolkit/equipment needs assessment: 13 participants. PAC supplies and specialized translocation truck authorized for procurement; advertising planned for Q2.
Component 2 – Zoonotic and animal disease surveillance	Preparatory work only. Key action plans and community awareness activities scheduled for Q3–Q4 or FY28. Zoonotic surveillance units/laboratory equipment and related capacity building had not started by Q1.
Component 3 – Community-led conservation and sustainable livelihoods	Draft WCTF Strategic Plan remained under public participation; ToR prepared for Wildlife Conservation Trust Fund funding/disbursement guidelines; SDW adopted Financial Policy and Procedures Manual. SAGE governance/equity assessments advanced in Il Ngwesi, Shulmai and Naibunga Upper. Small-grant selection criteria agreed for 15 conservancies/groups; RFP under development. Most livelihood/infrastructure activities planned for later quarters/FY28.
Component 4 – Coordination, learning and knowledge management	Project Steering Committee constituted and appointment letters issued; formal engagement and technical meetings planned for Q2/Q3. Contribution to 2026 GWP Annual Conference poster session in Lombok submitted. Knowledge Management Strategy scheduled for Q3; most dissemination products planned from FY28.
Component 5 – Monitoring and Evaluation	Results-monitoring training delivered during an earlier work planning workshop; quarterly reporting ongoing. METT/GEF tracking activities and annual PIR scheduled later in the year. Q1 report contains no financial expenditure/utilization except for Co-financing.

4. RESULTS TO CONTRIBUTION

Outcomes emerging: Q1 establishes readiness and coordination foundations, but no end-of-project outcome change can yet be demonstrated. Assessment completion and partner coordination are early enabling results.

Indicator progress: Earth Ranger site assessments completed; procurement packages in preparation; HWC data-review and toolkit needs assessments conducted; small-grant criteria agreed; PSC constituted; quarterly reporting ongoing. Most physical delivery targets remain at procurement phase, planning or pre-implementation stage.

Evidence Technical, Operational and Site Assessment Report, HWC data-review workshop, HWC toolkit and engagement Needs Assessment, Community consent, Women's Forum Endorsement, ToRs of Women Forum formation, ToR WCTF

Funding and Disbursement Guidelines, Governance and Equity assessments, SDW agreement with CI, Project Steering Committee appointment letters, Monthly check in calls for August & September, PMU Co-finance secured and Zambia Twinning Visit, PMU dedicated project account, PMU staff completed CI-GEF compliance online trainings and certificates issued,

5. CONTRIBUTION TO INTERNATIONAL COMMITMENTS

During Q1, the project contributed to SDG 15 (Life on Land), SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being), and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals) through human-wildlife conflict stakeholder engagement, community needs assessments, and coordination on HWC data sharing. These achievements align with the project's objectives and relevant biodiversity conservation and community-led conservation commitments outlined in the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.

6. FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

COMPONENT	APPROVED BUDGET	EXPENDITURE	UTILISATION %	BALANCE	VARIANCE / REMARKS
Component 1	2,002,347.55	35,617.85	2	1,966,729.70	SDW is yet to receive 10% advance and hence no expenditures recorded. .
Component 2	734,878.72	87.98	0	734,790.74	
Component 3	825,036.74	65,925.43	8	759,111.31	
Component 4	105,533.33	Nil	0	105,533.33	
Component 5	45,607.60	163.04	0	45,444.56	
Project Management Costs	72,447.14	4,045.19	6	68,401.95	

PARTNER	COMMITTED	REALISED TO DATE	% REALISED	EVIDENCE / REMARKS
SDW	696,887.16	181,085.27	26	FY26 co-financing report submitted;
CI	1,427,345.00			
KWCA	1,750,000.00			FY26 co-financing report submitted;
TTWCA	500,000.00			
LCA	750,000.00			
KWS	44,784,298.23	10,215,098.17	23	FY26 co-financing report submitted;
WRTI	4,518,821.49	904,524.90	20	FY26 co-financing report submitted;
Total	54,427,345			

7. CHALLENGES AND IMPLEMENTATION BOTTLENECKS

RISK / ISSUE	RATING	POTENTIAL EFFECT	MITIGATION / RESPONSE	RESPONSIBLE	STATUS
Delayed disbursement of funds from National Treasury	High	Delays to partner implementation and disbursements	Continue follow-up with Treasury. Q1 risk register says project account secured, funds disbursed, while project information notes prior delay.	SDW / PMU / CI	The funds have been disbursed to SDW and Project implementation scheduled for next quarters in preparatory phase
Procurement and approval delays	High	Slower delivery of technology, HWC equipment and infrastructure	Finalized packages and obtain CI concurrence; sequence procurement against technical readiness.	PMU, CI, KWS, KWCA	Ongoing
ESIA/ESMP and FPIC documentation incomplete	High	Safeguard non-compliance or delay to construction	Complete site-specific assessments, management plans and documented consent before works; recruit Environmental and safeguards officer.	SDW, KWCA, KWS, WRTI	Ongoing
Gender participation below benchmark in one workshop	Medium	Reduced inclusion and weaker gender-responsive outcomes	Use proactive outreach and scheduling to reach ≥30% women; monitor participation by sex and age.	LCA, TTWCA, PMU	Ongoing
Zoonotic surveillance and	Medium	Delayed progress on disease monitoring outcomes	Advance procurement, sustainability planning and training; prioritize Q3/Q4 activities.	WRTI, KWS, SDW	Planned

technical capacity not yet deployed					

Additional risks/issues: ESIA/ESMP and FPIC documentation is incomplete for relevant infrastructure; recruitment of the Environmental and Social Safeguards Officer remains pending.

8. COORDINATION AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

The PMU coordinated with CI and SDW, KWS, WRTI, KWCA, LCA and TTWCA. Project Steering Committee constituted and appointment letters issued. HWC data-sharing arrangements discussed: KWS to provide raw data, WRTI to analyze it, and findings to be shared with landscape partners. PSC/technical meetings planned for Q2, procurement process ongoing.

INDICATOR / GROUP	TARGET	ACHIEVED	% ACHIEVED	REMARKS
Stakeholder participation – women	≥30% in relevant activities	49 women of 133 participants	36.8%	Aggregate Q1 engagement exceeds benchmark; workshop-level variation remains.
Stakeholder participation – men	Disaggregate and monitor	84 of 133 participants	63.2%	Q1 workshops, needs assessments and consultations.
Youth participation	Track inclusion	13 youth engaged	Not calculable against Q1 target	Reported in community consultation/engagement data.
LCA HWC data-review workshop – women	≥30% benchmark	12 of 57 participants	21.1%	Below benchmark; future sessions to improve proactive engagement.
TTWCA HWC toolkit/equipment assessment – women	≥30% benchmark	5 of 13 participants	38.5%	Above benchmark.

9. NEXT STEPS

PRIORITY	PLANNED ACTIVITIES	TIMELINE	EXPECTED RESULT
Procurement readiness	Secure CI concurrence on procurement	FY27 Q2–Q3	Procurement initiated and priority systems on track for deployment.
Safeguards and community consent	Finalize Naibunga ecological survey RFP, ESIA/ESMP and outstanding FPIC records before works; recruit Environmental and safeguards officer;	Q2 and before works	Safeguards-compliant, community-supported implementation.
Zoonotic surveillance	Advance procurement/planning for surveillance units, laboratory tools, action plans and capacity building.	Q3–Q4; some FY28	Surveillance readiness and capacity strengthened.
Coordination and accountability	Hold PSC/technical meetings; continue coordination with other implementing partners	Q2–Q3	Clear decisions and evidence-based HWC response.
Financial reporting	Submit FY27 co-financing report and validate expenditure, utilization, balances and partner co-financing figures.	Q2	Complete financial and co-financing reporting.

10. KEY DECISIONS / SUPPORT REQUIRED

ISSUE	DECISION / SUPPORT REQUIRED	INSTITUTION / LEVEL	TIMELINE	STATUS
Procurement approvals	Timely review/concurrence for all procurement packages.	CI / PMU / implementing partners	Q2	Pending/under preparation
PMU fully constituted and operational	Resolve any remaining treasury bottlenecks.	SDW / National Treasury /	Immediate	Funds disbursed in QI, procurement to be finalized in the subsequent quarters and implementation to proceed
Safeguards readiness	Support completion of ESIA/ESMP and FPIC requirements and expedite safeguards/gender officer recruitment.	SDW / CI / KWCA / KWS / WRTI	Before infrastructure works	Open
Financial and co-financing data	Provide validated expenditure, utilization, balance and partner-level co-financing figures for OFP reporting.	PMU / SDW / KWCA / partners	Next reporting period	Not included in Q1 report, scheduled for Q2

Gender inclusion	Ensure ≥30% women's participation in workshops, committees and technical activities.	All partners / landscape associations	Ongoing	Action required after one workshop at 21.1% women

11. PERFORMANCE REPORTING FORMAT

PROJECTED OUTPUT	ACTIVITIES	PERFORMANCE INDICATOR / TARGET	ACHIEVEMENT	VARIANCE / COMMENTS	STATUS
C1 – Earth Ranger command center	Complete technical, operational and site assessments	Assessment complete	1 command center + 2 sub-centers	Readiness achieved; infrastructure pending	On track with procurement delays
C1 – Technology required	Complete technology needs assessment and prepare procurement	Needs assessment completed; procurement package being prepared	Meru NP + 6 OECMs	No deployment reported; CI concurrence pending	Delayed
C1 – HWC action plans/interventions	HWC data review and toolkit/equipment needs assessment	57 LCA workshop participants; 13 TTWCA assessment participants	At least 3 action plans; ≥30% women/marginalized participation	Assessments/workshops initiated; interventions pending	Under implementation
C1 – Naibunga corridor	Prepare ecological survey RFP	RFP drafted and circulated for review	47,700 ha corridor secured	Procurement preparation only; survey/fencing not completed	Delayed pending RFP clearance
C2 – Zoonotic disease mechanisms	Prepare surveillance plans/tools/frameworks	No field delivery reported	At least 20 mechanisms/tools/frameworks	Surveillance unit/lab activities not started	Not started / planned
C3 – Small grants	Agree criteria and develop RFP	Criteria agreed; RFP under development	15 organizations/conservancies strengthened	No grants disbursed in Q1	Under implementation
C4 – Knowledge exchange/coordination	Constitute PSC and initiate knowledge exchange	PSC constituted; appointment letters issued; poster contribution submitted	Coordinate with ≥2 landscape initiatives and ≥1 regional/global initiative	Coordination foundations in place	Under implementation
C5 – M&E	Quarterly reporting and results monitoring	Quarterly reporting ongoing; earlier M&E training conducted	5 annual PIRs over project life	Q1 Report shared; FY26 co-financing report shared	Ongoing

12. OTHER COMMENTS OR RECOMMENDATIONS

Prioritize timely CI concurrence and procurement approvals; complete site-specific ESIA/ESMP and FPIC documentation before works; recruit the Environmental and safeguards/ officer; ensure at least 30% women's participation in relevant activities;

Adaptive management: Q1 Reported delays in implementation, activities scheduled for Q2.

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